

MIND

— AND —

MODERN PROBLEMS

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FOREWORD

Modern man has lost his soul in the pursuit of worldly pleasures. In this world of cut-throat competition and in the rat race to riches he forgot his true nature which is Self. The nature of Self is Satchidananda – Existence Absolute, Knowledge Absolute and Bliss Absolute. One needs to meditate on these words to understand the inner meaning and purport. That is every thing about us is relative and impermanent. Only Truth or Soul or Self or God is Absolute, Infinite and Permanent.

Man is constantly running around all the time under tremendous pressure. He is not able to cope up with the day to day problems. As a result there are more heartaches and more heart-brakes. All because he doesn't know his true glory; he doesn't know the real purpose and meaning of life.

Perhaps, never before man was as uncomfortable with his mind as he is today. Paradoxically today everyone believes the present era as the most advanced phase of human civilization and yet, the feeling of unfulfillment in life or dissatisfaction with oneself was never as high as it is now. Meditation centres are thriving; people are thirsting for spirituality and searching for methods to control the mind. Mind has become a big source of problem. As the problem has arisen they are seeking solution.

But the sage of Vedic India didn't wait till his mind became a source of great trouble to him. He just explored it as the scientist of modern era explores the external world. We can even call him mind-scientist or spiritual-scientist. The same scientific tempo a modern day scientist employs to discover something of the material world, the sage of yore employed to investigate the nature of the mind. Through such an investigation he analyzed the in and outs of the thing called mind, and devised methods to control and conquer it. The same knowledge has come to us through the corridor of time. All the methods described in India's spiritual literature have this one aim of helping man control his mind. In this small compendium called 'Mind and modern problems' a humble attempt has been made to analyze the factors responsible for the scattering and dissipation of mental energy in the present day context. And how to concentrate the mind through a disciplined life and steady spiritual practices has been dealt with in a lucid way. Meditation, personality, thought power, will-power, managing the emotions, stress and the means to overcome it are some of the things that are touched and some practical hints are given.

It is our sincere hope that the reader finds the book interesting from the perspective of forming an understanding on the nature of mind, the need and the method to control it. If this book paves the way for a more peaceful and fulfilling life even in one individual we consider our effort has not gone in vain.

Publisher's Note (2nd reprint)

On the occasion of the 150th birth anniversary Celebrations of Swami Vivekananda (2012-2014) which is being observed all over the country, we are extremely happy to publish a small compendium on the most important and vital topic of the times, 'MIND & MODERN PROBLEMS'. This is a very complex subject and many a great Sage, Saint, Professor, a Spiritual Seeker, a student or even a common man has been caught unawares by its play.

There are hundreds of books and articles on the topic of the mind and its control, behavior and other related facets but we felt that a small book which can stimulate fresh enthusiasm and which can act as a guidepost for more detailed study on the subject for the youngsters and students is necessary. Hence this book in your hands!! We are happy to inform the reader that within a short span of 3 months all the copies have been sold out and we are bringing out a reprint of the book for the benefit of many other young readers.

We would like to thank Br. Niyama Chaitanya of Ramakrishna Math, Hyderabad, Dr. Sumita Roy, Osmania University, Hyderabad and many others who have helped us in many ways for the outcome of this book. We are sure that the Lives and teachings of many great men and women and the Holy Trinity will motivate the youth to lead a more matured and peaceful and positive life.

- Publisher

INTRODUCTION

The Problems of the Mind:

Today we have bigger houses and smaller families; more conveniences, but less time; we have more degrees, but less common sense; more knowledge, less judgment. We have more experts, but more problems; more medicine, but less wellness. We spend too recklessly, laugh too little, drive too fast, get angry too quickly, stay up too late, get up too tired, read too little, and pray too seldom. We have multiplied our possessions, but reduced our values. We talk too much, love too little and lie too often. We have learned how to make a living, but not a life; we have added years to life, not life to years. Today we have taller buildings, but shorter tempers; wider freeways, but narrower viewpoints. We spend more, have less; we buy more, enjoy less. We went all the way to the moon and back, but have trouble crossing the street to meet the new neighbor. We conquered outer space, but not inner space. We have split the atom, but not our prejudice; we write more, but learn less; plan more, but accomplish less. We learned to

rush, but not to wait; we have higher incomes, but lower morals. We build more computers to hold more information, to produce more copies, but have less real communication. We are long on quantity, but short on quality.

These are the times of fast foods but slow digestion and less nutrition; tall men and short character; steep profits and shallow relationships. Two incomes, but more divorces; fancier houses, but broken homes!

We don't think we are presenting a cynical view of the world. The reader can go through from the beginning and recheck the truth of the above statements! If not in our lives, these are the commonly known happenings of the world around us. Thanks to the newspapers and electronic media which keep us informed about all these happenings!

In this book we would like to present some of these modern day problems and their suggested solutions. "Spirituality is not for the empty belly"—Sri Ramakrishna would say. Here, we may not be empty bellied, but probably *empty minded* or *empty hearted*. Ramakrishna Order does not try to serve only the spiritual needs of the people, but also their intellectual, mental and sometimes physical needs.

This is our idea of worship and service to the Lord. Really, these various dimensions of human personality are not unintegrated. If one's physical needs like food, shelter, clothing, warmth, health and even reasonable comfort are not taken care of, the mind cannot lift itself from the body and aspire to higher spheres like arts, science, pursuit of knowledge and religion. And when a man is fed, educated and given a job he invites new problems like lack of discipline, recklessness, whiling away time in daydreaming, poor social ability, lack of necessary skills, lack of clarity in thought, word and deed. Taking things much more to heart than required creates pressure and stress. Lack of proper upbringing, culture and higher ideas cause an individual to pursue animal pleasures.

Most educational institutions are focused on producing top rankers alone. There are a shockingly high number of schools which do not have playgrounds, or moral science classes or creative teachers. If a pupil comes to high school, he/she is pressurized from all sides—parents, teachers and relatives—to achieve a top rank or high percentage in exams. Competition kills creativity. Young students' aptitudes are not considered important. Sports, music, drawing and other such fields are considered to be only